ATLAS · Market Intel

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- 📡   Tuesday 13 May · 11:00 UTC · macro briefing · live intel   📡
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║   📡  MARKET INTEL — LIVE MACRO BRIEFING         ║
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2 major events landing in the next 6 hours.
Combined risk state: CAUTION — see operational read below.

📘 EXPANDED TERMINOLOGY HYPERLINKS

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CPI]  Hawkish]  Dovish]  Risk-On / Risk-Off]  Yield Spread]  VIX]
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╔══════════════════════════════════════════════════╗
║   🌐  GLOBAL MARKET MOOD  &  RISK STATE          ║
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▸  Risk State  ·  CAUTION  🟠🟠🟠🟠  (4 / 5)
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What **Market Mood** means right now:
Markets are sensitive. A US **CPI** inflation reading
at 12:30 UTC plus an ECB Lagarde speech at 14:00 UTC create

a 90-minute window where surprises can move dollar pairs, gold, and US equities in a coordinated way.

What this means for trader behaviour today (dollars-first):
🟢 Pre-event window — keep ALL your dollar-pair positions sized down to **60% of your normal trade size**. On a $10,000 account, that means risking $300 per trade instead of the usual $500. Why: bigger swings = wider stops needed = more $$$ at risk per trade.
🟡 During CPI (12:30 → 12:35 UTC) — do NOT trade. Do NOT add to open positions. The first 60 seconds after the print routinely whips $500–$1,000 against any position on a standard $100k EURUSD lot.
🟠 After CPI (12:35 → 14:00 UTC) — wait for the 5-min candle close at 12:35 to read direction. Then re-size, still at 60% of normal until Lagarde finishes.
🛑 If BOTH CPI and Lagarde surprise on the hawkish side: stand aside entirely for the rest of the session.

Why this rating, not lower or higher:
Risk would be RED (5/5) if a central-bank rate decision were landing this cycle — there isn't. Risk would be YELLOW (3/5) if only ONE of these two events were on the calendar today.

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║   📅  MAJOR EVENTS  ·  NEXT 24 HOURS              ║
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12:30 UTC   US CPI (inflation announcement)   🟠🟠🟠🟠   HIGH
14:00 UTC   ECB Lagarde — scheduled speech    🟡🟡🟡     MEDIUM
21:00 UTC   FOMC Daly — fireside chat          🟡🟡       LOW-MEDIUM
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▸ Why these events matter (plain English)

CPI is the monthly inflation reading that decides whether
the Fed will keep tightening or hold steady at its next meeting.
When CPI comes in HIGHER than expected, that's **hawkish** —
it pushes the US dollar up and pressures equities and gold.
When it comes in LOWER, that's **dovish** — the opposite happens.
Lagarde's speech follows ~90 minutes later and often re-prices
the euro relative to whatever direction CPI took.

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- 🆕  PRIMARY EVENT  ·  US CPI · 12:30 UTC
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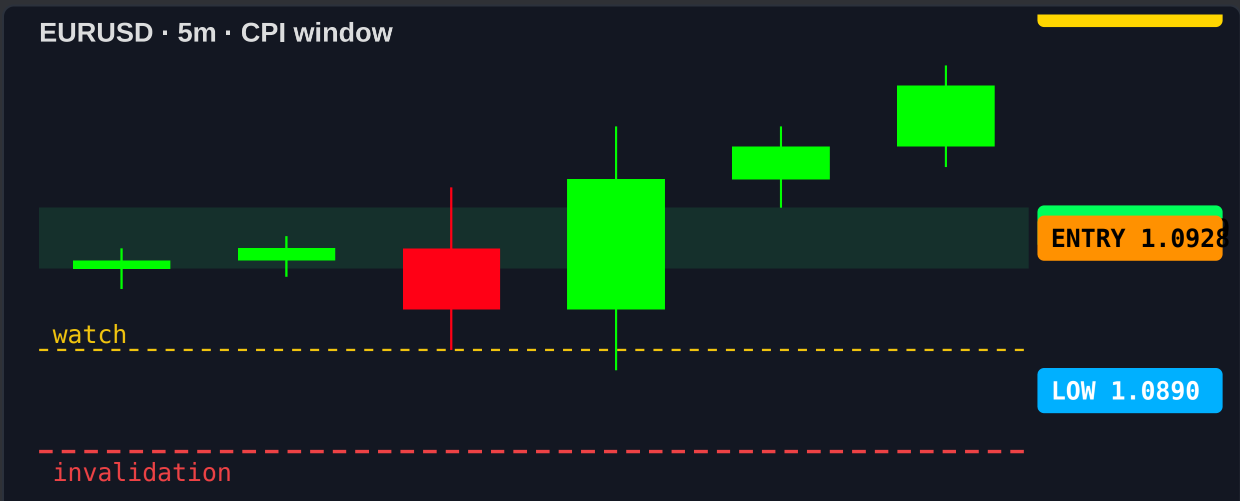
🇺🇸 · US CPI · April release · 🟠 HIGH

US Consumer Price Index (the monthly inflation reading). It is the single biggest catalyst for the dollar this week. The reading decides whether the Fed leans hawkish or dovish at its next meeting.



ATLAS chart card preview · EURUSD 5m · pre-event calm → T-0 chaos → post-settle direction

WHEN

Today · 12:30 UTC

IMPACT

🟠 HIGH · tier-1 catalyst

AFFECTED MARKETS

DXY · EURUSD · GBPUSD · USDJPY ·
XAUUSD · US500 · NDX

💲 **DOLLAR IMPACT RANGE**

💲 **Typical first-60-second swing range (historical CPI prints, last 12 releases):**

💲 **$500 – $1,000 against any position on a standard $100k EURUSD lot.**

💲 **$1,200 – $2,500 on 1 standard lot XAUUSD (100 oz).**

💲 **$400 – $900 on 100 shares of a US large-cap during initial reaction.**

💲 **Median post-settle (12:35 → 14:00) trend move: $700 – $1,400 on $100k EURUSD.**

WHAT TRADERS SHOULD WATCH · PRE / DURING / POST

🟢 BEFORE — Cut all dollar-pair positions to 60% of your normal trade size by 12:25 UTC. Why: pre-print volatility makes wider stops necessary, which means more $$$ at risk per trade.
🟡 DURING — Do NOT trade between 12:30 and 12:35 UTC. Do NOT add to open positions. The first 60 seconds is noise — the 12:35 candle close shows the real direction.
🟠 AFTER — Wait for the 12:35 UTC 5-min candle close. Identify direction. Only re-enter on the cleanest setups that match the direction the market chose. Still at 60% size until Lagarde finishes at ~14:30 UTC.

ATLAS · Market Intel · Today · 12:30 UTC · monitor in #market-intel

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- 🆕 REACTION PATHS · WHAT THE 4 OUTCOMES MEAN FOR YOU
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║ 🎯 POSSIBLE MARKET REACTION PATHS              ║
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Hawkish] Dovish] In-Line] Initial-Direction Reversal]
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▸ IF CPI announced HIGHER than forecast · -hawkish)
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Affected markets: DXY · EURUSD · GBPUSD · USDJPY · XAUUSD · US500

Expected behaviour:
• DXY pushes higher — buyers pile into the dollar
• EURUSD / GBPUSD drop on dollar strength
• US indices (US500 / NDX) drop on rate-hike fears
• Gold (XAUUSD) initially drops; can recover on safe-haven flow

💲 Dollar impact (first 30 minutes after the announcement):
• Long EURUSD trades: $300 – $800 drawdown on $100k notional
• Short EURUSD trades: $300 – $800 gain on $100k notional
• Long XAUUSD trades: $500 – $1,500 drawdown on 1 lot

What you should do:
✘ Do NOT enter new long-dollar positions in the first 5 minutes — chase risk is high.
✘ Do NOT add to any short-dollar positions.
✓ Exit short-dollar positions on the 5-min close at 12:35 UTC if direction holds.
✓ After 12:35 UTC, look for SHORT EURUSD setups using the next Dark Horse scan as your guide.

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▸  IF  CPI announced LOWER than forecast  ·  -dovish)
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Affected markets: DXY · EURUSD · GBPUSD · US500 · XAUUSD

Expected behaviour:
• DXY pulls back — sellers exit dollar longs
• EURUSD / GBPUSD rally on dollar weakness
• US indices rally on rate-cut optimism
• Gold rises with the broader risk-on flow

💲 Dollar impact (first 30 minutes after the announcement):
• Long EURUSD trades: $300 – $800 gain on $100k notional
• Short EURUSD trades: $300 – $800 drawdown on $100k notional
• Long XAUUSD trades: $500 – $1,500 gain on 1 lot

What you should do:
✘ Do NOT enter new short-dollar positions in the first 5 minutes.
✘ Do NOT add to any long-dollar positions.
✓ Exit long-dollar positions on the 5-min close at 12:35 UTC.

✓ After 12:35 UTC, look for LONG EURUSD / LONG XAUUSD setups using the next Dark Horse scan as your guide.

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▸ IF  CPI announced IN-LINE with forecast
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Affected markets: light reaction across the board

Expected behaviour:
• Initial spike either side then settle. No clean directional bias.
• Markets re-focus on Lagarde at 14:00 UTC.
• Volatility drops within 15 minutes.

💲 Dollar impact: small. $100 – $300 swings on $100k EURUSD, then mean-reversion back toward pre-event level.

What you should do:
✘ Do NOT trade the initial spike — it will settle.
✓ Stand aside through 12:35 UTC. Re-read at next ATLAS scan.
✓ Re-engage normally once Lagarde delivers at 14:00 UTC.

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▸ IF  the first move reverses within 10 minutes  ·  -initial-direction-rever
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This happens roughly 1 in 4 CPI prints — more often in high-volatility regimes like this one.

Expected behaviour:
• The first direction off the print is faded by 12:40 UTC.
• Volume comes IN against the initial move.
• The 15-min close at 12:45 UTC is the real trend.

💲 Dollar impact (a particularly punishing window):
• Traders who chase the first 60 seconds: $800 – $1,500 drawdown on $100k EURUSD before the reversal completes.

What you should do:
✘ Do NOT chase the first move under any circumstance.

✘ Do NOT add to positions on the initial direction.
✓ Wait for the 15-min candle close at 12:45 UTC.
✓ Trade only the post-12:45 direction — that's the actual signal.

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- 🆕 RISK ESCALATION · PRE / DURING / POST CPI
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║   ⚠ RISK ESCALATION · TIME-WINDOWED BEHAVIOUR║
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Risk Escalation]  Stand Aside]  Position Sizing]  Volatility Window]
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🟢 HEALTHY · Pre-print window (now → 12:25 UTC)
   Normal trade-management rules apply, with one change:
   reduce all dollar-pair positions to 60% of your normal size
   by 12:25. Use this window to close losing trades and tighten
   risk on winners.
   💲 Cost of staying full size into 12:30: $200 – $400 in extra
   drawdown on a $100k EURUSD position from wider whips alone.

🟡 CAUTION · T-5 minutes (12:25 → 12:30 UTC)
   Close any open dollar-pair / gold / US-index positions UNLESS
   they are >1.5R in profit and your stop is already at break-even.
   💲 Why: at T-0, those positions face $500 – $1,000 first-minute
   swing risk on $100k notional EURUSD.
   Action: tighten stops to break-even or step aside.

🟠 DANGER · T-0 to T+5 (12:30 → 12:35 UTC)
   The print moment. Markets routinely whip $500 – $1,000 against
   any position on $100k EURUSD in the first 60 seconds.
   Action: stand aside. Watch the 5-min candle form. Do NOT trade.

🛑 STAND ASIDE · If both CPI and Lagarde surprise hawkish
   Combined surprise from both events would re-price the dollar
   for the rest of the session.
   💲 Expected combined post-event move: $1,500 – $3,000 on $100k
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EURUSD over the 2-hour window after Lagarde.
Action: wait for the 15-min close AFTER Lagarde finishes
(~14:30 UTC) before resuming any new trades.

🟢 RE-ENTRY  ·  12:35 UTC onwards
Re-read structure on the 5m chart. Match against the four
reaction paths above. Act only on the cleanest setups that
match the actual direction the market chose at the 12:35 close.
💲 Continue at 60% size until Lagarde finishes; return to normal
sizing only after the 14:30 UTC re-read at the next ATLAS scan.
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▸ **What changes this risk state**

- If CPI cancels (rare): state drops to YELLOW (3/5).
- If a central-bank rate decision is added: state climbs to RED (5/5).
- If Lagarde's speech is cancelled: state drops to YELLOW (3/5).

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- 🆕  WHAT TO WATCH  ·  PRE / DURING / POST CPI
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║  👀  WHAT TRADERS SHOULD WATCH (each row carries action)║
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DXY]  Yield Spread]  VIX]  Liquidity]  Hawkish]
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▸ **Pre-event indicators (now → 12:25 UTC)**

DXY above 105 — what it means: the dollar has ALREADY moved up in anticipation of a hawkish CPI. Action: do NOT bet on further dollar strength unless CPI surprises EVEN HOTTER than expected. The easy long-dollar trade is already priced in.

front-end yields above 4.85% — what it means: the bond market is also already positioned for a hawkish reading. Action: same as DXY above — be cautious of fresh long-dollar entries.

VIX above 18 — what it means: traders are nervous about the print. Equity downside risk is elevated. Action: do NOT take fresh long-equity positions before 12:30 UTC.
VIX below 14 — what it means: traders are complacent. A surprise print will hit harder. Action: avoid new positions in any market until 12:35 UTC.

EURUSD position into the print — what it means: where the market thinks the dollar is heading. If EURUSD is at the high of its 24-hour range entering the print, the market is leaning DOVISH. Action: a HAWKISH surprise from a dovishly-positioned market causes the BIGGEST whips. Cut size further if EURUSD is at the day's high entering 12:30 UTC.

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▸ During the event (12:30 → 12:35 UTC)
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• The first 60 seconds of price action is NOISE. Do not act on it.
• Watch the 5m candle CLOSE at 12:35 UTC — that prints the real direction.
• Read DXY first, THEN look at EURUSD / XAUUSD response.
Why: DXY is the leading indicator for dollar-pair direction.
• Action: stand aside the whole 5-minute window.

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▸ Post-event reassessment (12:35 → 14:00 UTC)
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• Did the initial direction HOLD or REVERSE inside 10 minutes?
If reversed: trade only the post-12:45 direction. The initial move was wrong.

• Is volume CONFIRMING the move or FADING?
Confirming = sustained large candle bodies in the direction.
Fading = candle bodies shrinking — direction is exhausting.
Action: only enter trades when volume is confirming.
• What did treasuries do?
Bonds move opposite to yields. If yields jumped, bonds fell — that confirms a HAWKISH read. Action: trade in line with bonds for the cleanest signal.
• Wait for Lagarde 14:00 UTC before sizing INTO new trades.
Action: small size or stand aside in the window 13:00 → 14:00.

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- 🆕 EVENT-DAY REFERENCE · THE 4 WINDOWS
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║ 📚 EVENT-DAY REFERENCE · THE 4 WINDOWS ║
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📚 How to read an event-day chart

Every macro event has 4 windows on the chart. Pre-event is your trading window with size reduced. T-0 is the chaos window — stand aside. Post-settle is when the real direction appears. T+30 onwards is when normal trading resumes.

ATLAS chart card preview · EURUSD 5m · pre-event calm → T-0 chaos → post-settle direction

THE STORY

Before CPI, candles are small and quiet (pre-event window). At 12:30 UTC the candle range explodes — that's the chaos window. By 12:35 UTC the noise settles and a clear direction emerges. From 12:40 onwards, the candles return to normal size and the trend is tradable.

HOW A TRADER USES THIS (CONCRETE)

🟢 Pre-event (T-5 to T-0): size at 60% of normal. Tighten stops.
🛑 T-0 (12:30 to 12:35 UTC): stand aside. Do NOT trade.
🟢 Post-settle (T+5 to T+15): re-read direction on the 12:35 close. Trade only that direction.
🟢 T+30 onwards: resume normal trading patterns.

💲 DOLLAR CONTEXT FOR EACH WINDOW

💲 Pre-event: $100 – $300 whips per 5m candle on $100k EURUSD.

💲 T-0 to T+5: $500 – $1,000 swings in 60 seconds.

💲 Post-settle (T+5 to T+15): $200 – $400 per 5m candle (settling).

💲 T+30+: back to $50 – $150 per 5m candle (normal).

RENDERED ATLAS EVENT CARDS — NEXT EVOLUTION

Future scans will replace the prototype chart with live ATLAS chart snapshots taken during real CPI prints, with all four windows annotated on the actual price action.

ATLAS · Market Intel · event-day reference · prototype render

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▸ Briefing summary

Two macro events land within 90 minutes today. Risk state is
CAUTION (4/5) for the next 6 hours.

Concrete action:
① Cut all dollar-pair positions to 60% of normal size by 12:25 UTC.
② Stand aside from 12:30 to 12:35 UTC (the T-0 window).
③ Re-read direction on the 12:35 UTC 5-minute candle close.
④ Trade only the post-settle direction at 60% size until Lagarde finishes.
⑤ ATLAS Market Intel next updates at 13:30 UTC with the post-CPI read.